

All information is kept in records, and this is maintained in the `/etc/passwd` file. Therefore, in this article, we are going to learn about the same as well as the ways in which we can manage these groups and users.

What is a User?

Before going any further, we need to understand the basics of user and group management. A user is defined as the account that helps in providing secured boundaries between programs and the people to run commands. Every user that works on the platform has a username; this distinguishes them from the bots or computer. This helps in identifying a person's existence on the platform. When you create a user name, internally the computer assigns an ID and a secret password that you punch to log in. These are known as the user's login credentials. Each time the person logs into the account, they have to punch in these credentials, which are cross-checked by the computer. This is how user and group management resonate together to keep the information in the folder secured and safe.



```

root@JavaTpoint: ~
root@JavaTpoint:~# useradd -D
GROUP=100
HOME=/home
INACTIVE=-1
EXPIRE=
SHELL=/bin/sh
SKEL=/etc/skel
CREATE_MAIL_SPOOL=no
root@JavaTpoint:~#
  
```

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Every time you create a user account, a group account with the same name gets created.

Another important thing to understand while learning about user accounts is that they are fundamental to all the system securities. Every process that you run on the system runs as a particular user, meaning it is designated to some account, folder, and files; this means, every file that exists on the computer has a particular user and so it also has an owner. With the help of this file ownership, the system enforces access control for every file and its users. This then leads to a complete chain of process where the files and directories that are accessible to a running account are tallied. As we have already discussed, there is a small extension in this—user accounts are of three types: regular user, system users, and superusers. The names that are given to these accounts are self-explanatory, as superuser accounts of the systems are for administration purposes. If you have such an account, it will be the root account